

5-Month Certification Roadmap

Candidate: Matthew Linke | **Target:** Cloud Identity & Security Architect | **Market:** Vancouver/Portland

ROADMAP SNAPSHOT

MONTH	CERTIFICATION	CAREER IMPACT	SALARY TARGET
Month 1	MS-102 (M365 Admin)	Validates Intune/MDM Expertise	\$100,000
Month 3	Security+ (DoD 8570)	Opens Govt/Banking Sectors	\$115,000
Month 5	SC-300 (Cloud Identity)	Elite Identity Architect Status	\$130,000+

MONTH 1: FOUNDATION

MS-102: Microsoft 365 Administrator Associate

Converts 15 years of support experience into a modern "Cloud Admin" credential. Proves you can manage the full user lifecycle in ZoomInfo or Unitus-level environments.

- Complete "Zero-Trust Sandbox" Project (Week 3)
- Document Autopilot enrollment workflows

MONTH 3: COMPLIANCE

CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701)

The "Hard Requirement" for many local high-paying roles. Removes the HR filter for security-conscious organizations and government agencies in Vancouver.

- Map to existing Cisco Cybersecurity Essentials cert
- Focus on RMF and STIG compliance for "Cleared" roles

MONTH 5: ARCHITECTURE

SC-300: Identity & Access Administrator

The elite specialized credential. Shifts your market value from "Device Management" to "Enterprise Security Architecture."

- Document Hybrid Identity Bridge (Okta to Entra ID)
- Position as high-value architect for \$140k+ roles